

1. Ethical Dilemma Response

Scenario:

Confidential Breach Report Ignored

Jay, an IT Supervisor at a U.S.-based SaaS firm, is approached by Priya, a junior developer, who reports a suspected security breach in their application's admin dashboard. Jay's department is under heavy pressure to deliver a new feature. His own manager hints to "not make waves"—downplaying the report to meet the release deadline.

- Issue: Subordinate's security concern is being minimized for productivity gains.
- Decision: Jay chooses to escalate the incident to the compliance team, pausing feature deployment until the issue is properly investigated.
- Ethical Principle: *Accountability and Integrity*: Protecting customer data is non-negotiable even when deadlines are tight.
- Leadership Justification: By supporting Priya and following the escalation process, Jay reinforces a culture where team members feel safe reporting issues—essential for both ethical leadership and cyber resilience.

"As a leader, I would rather face delay than risk the legitimacy and trust of my organization."